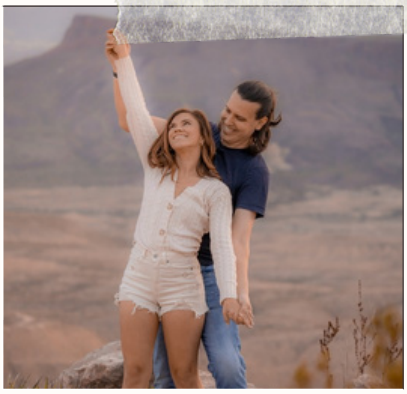
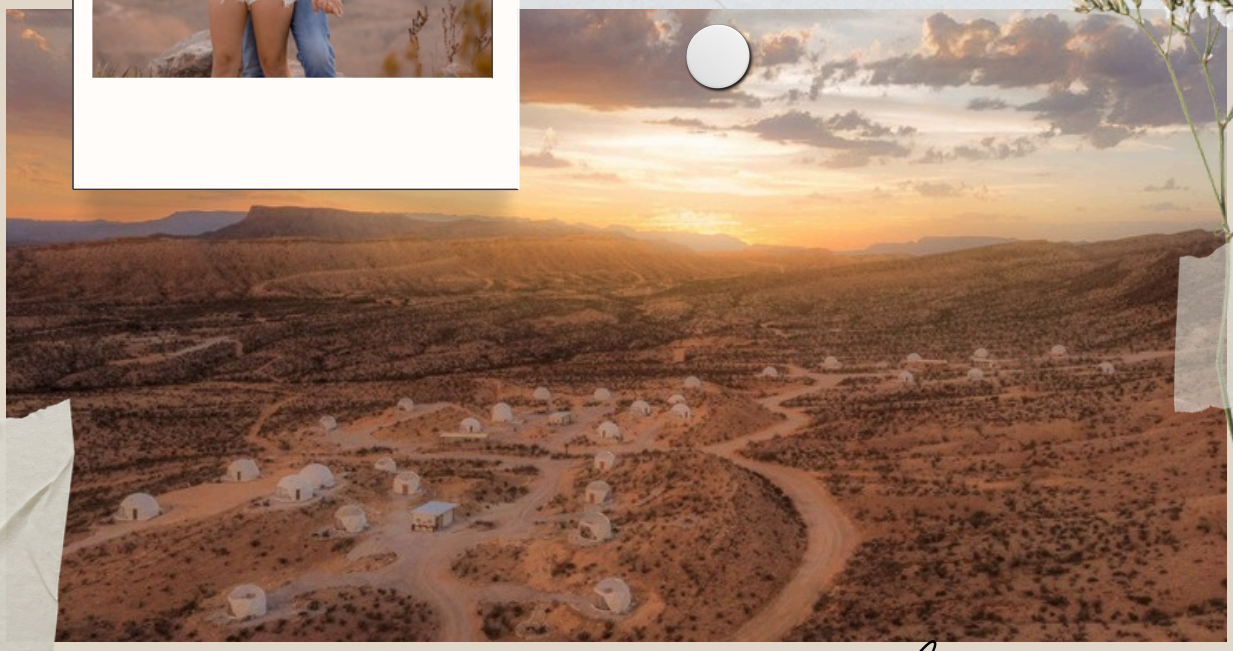

Start Your Adventure
The Summit Guidebook





LIVE IN
THE MOMENT





#thesummit

welcome

On behalf of our entire team, we extend to you the warmest welcome. We are thrilled to have you join us and are committed to making your stay not just comfortable, but truly memorable.

As you embark on your adventure, immerse yourself in the unique experiences that await you. Whether you're here to relax, explore, or simply to enjoy a moment away from the everyday, we're here to ensure your journey is as perfect as the breathtaking landscape surrounding us.

Should you need anything to enhance your stay, don't hesitate to reach out. We're more than happy to assist. Here's to a great stay and an unforgettable adventure at The Summit!

-The Summit at Big Bend Team

TABLE OF CONTENTS

03 *Welcome*

04 *Table of contents*

06 *Contact and Wifi*

08 *Travel Advice*

10 *Property Info*





12 Exploring The Summit

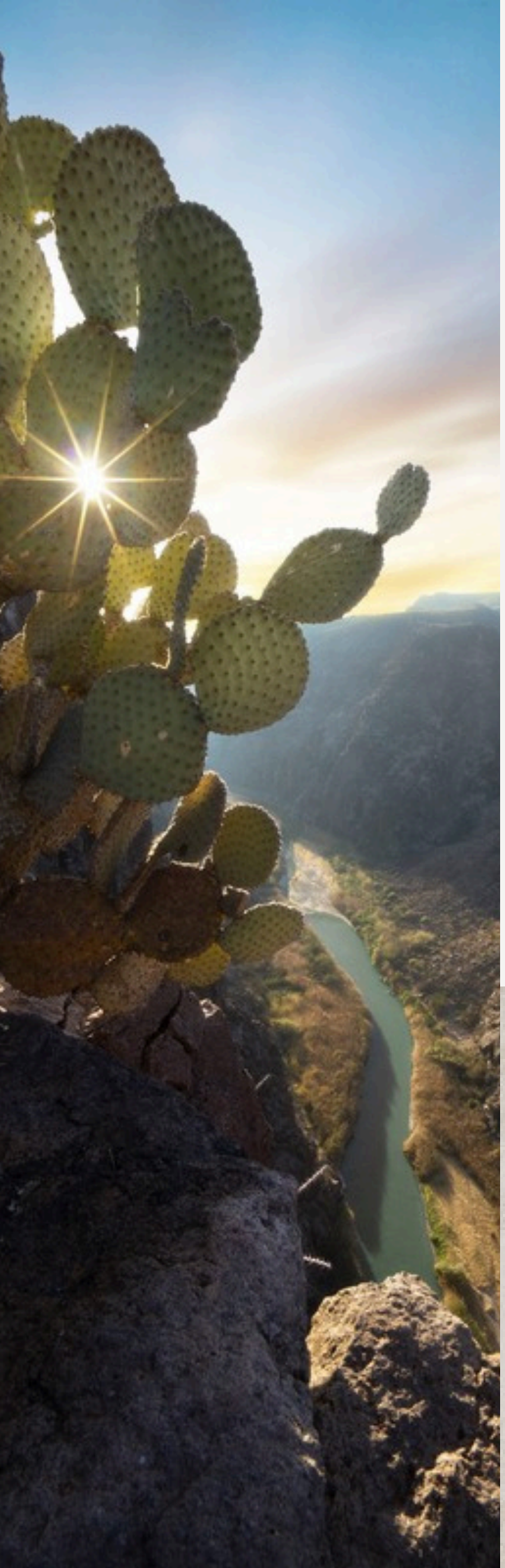
13 Our History

14 Big Bend National Park

17 Things to Do

18 Where to Eat

20 Frequently Asked Q’s



Contact Info

CONTACT INFO

Guest Services: 432-220-3383 (Voice or Text)
Email: info@summitbigbend.com
Address: 2500 N Lone Star Mine, Terlingua, TX

EMERGENCY INFO

Terlingua Fire and EMS: 432-371-2536
Big Bend Medical Center: 432-837-3447
Brewster County Sheriff: 432-837-3488

Checking In

We'll warmly welcome you for check-in at 3PM. Check-out is promptly at 10AM. Our unique desert setting requires that extra touch to ensure everything's perfect. Thanks for understanding as we tailor a pristine retreat, especially for you!

We are entirely self check-in!
Check-in: 3PM
Check-out: 10AM

WIFI INFORMATION

Network: Strongest Open Network
Password: No Password Required



CUSTOMER SERVICE

Your comfort is our top priority. Have a question or facing an issue? Don't hesitate to text us anytime, 24/7. We encourage you to reach out as soon as something comes up. That way, we can jump right on it and ensure your stay remains top-notch!

BEFORE YOU ARRIVE

Road Conditions: *Our access route is a well-maintained, hard-packed dirt road. While 4x4 vehicles are not essential, we advise against bringing sports cars due to their lower clearance.*

Services En-Route: *Be aware that along Tx-118 between Alpine and Study Butte, services are sparse. There aren't any gas stations or stores, and cell service can be patchy. Ensure your vehicle has a full tank and is in tip-top shape before embarking on this stretch.*

Hydration is Key: *Big Bend region can be dry and hot. Always carry plenty of water with you, especially if you're planning on hiking or other outdoor activities.*

Wildlife Awareness: *The area is home to diverse wildlife. Be cautious of animals when driving, especially around dawn or dusk when many animals are most active.*

Pack Essentials: *Given the remote nature of Big Bend, make sure to pack essentials like snacks, first-aid kit, and any medicines you might need. While we provide a comfortable stay, it's always good to be prepared.*

Night Driving: *If you're unfamiliar with the area, try to avoid driving at night. Road signs can be sparse, and with minimal light pollution, it can get exceptionally dark, making navigation tricky.*

Digital Maps: *Cell service might be intermittent, so downloading the area map on your smartphone or GPS device in advance can be a lifesaver. Apps like Google Maps allow for offline map downloads.*

Weather Check: *The weather can change rapidly in desert regions. Checking the forecast for Big Bend before your trip will help you pack and plan appropriately.*



Travel Advice

PROPERTY POLICIES



No Smoking allowed inside any of our properties. Violation of this rule will result in a $150 charge to your stay.

No Pets are allowed on the property. Violation of this rule will result in a $100 charge to your stay per night per pet.

There will be a $25 fee (added to the cost of shipping) to mail any forgotten items back.

Check out is 10am. We ask that you be mindful of the times so our housekeeping team can have the appropriate amount of time to sanitize every space!

We are not liable for lost, stolen, damaged personal effects on our property or for the discomforts of nature. We are not responsible for injuries, deaths or vehicle troubles.

SOME TIPS



Power: While being in such an unspoiled, remote area has its advantages, the power grid can be less consistent. A downed power pole many miles up the road can send the whole county into darkness. Our power company monitors outages remotely and usually has things up and running in a few hours. If you are experiencing an isolated issue, please let us know immediately. If the entire property is out of power and you need cell service, head back down the road to Hwy 170 where you will have cell reception.

WIFI: Wi-Fi is available on-site to help you stay connected through calls, texts, and messaging. Signal strength and speeds vary, and you may need to step outside your accommodation for a better connection. This enables us to relay important on-site updates to you, especially given that cell service can be quite inconsistent in this region.

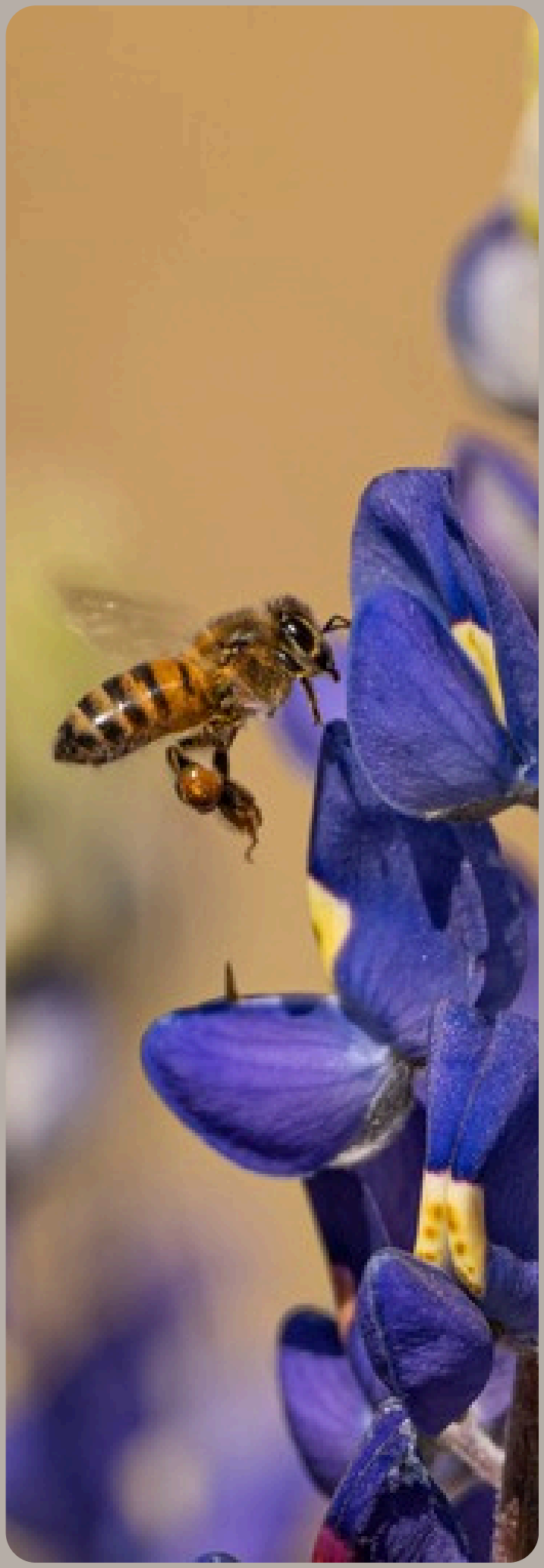
Bugs and Wildlife: Your comfort is our priority, and so we actively manage bugs with regular treatments by our staff and monthly professional services. Yet, our closeness to the wild might occasionally bring uninvited little guests. Should you encounter any issues, please inform us immediately so we can swiftly address it.

Property Info

Temperature Control: Welcome to the desert, where temperatures can be a wild ride! Your room (with the exception of Casa Grande) is equipped with a remote-controlled mini-split AC, which not only cools during summer days but also heats during the chilly winter months. During the intense heat of summer, it's natural for the domes to feel warm, but rest assured, once the sun sets, these powerful units will quickly cool your space. On the flip side, they'll keep you toasty warm during cooler months. Please let us know if you have any questions or need assistance with the AC settings.

Food & Cooking: We believe that food tastes better when cooked under the vast open skies! If your accommodation doesn't come with its own grill, experience authentic outdoor cooking at our propane kitchens located in sections 2 and 3. Just be sure to pack your favorite grill items and utensils. And if the propane runs low, give us a quick text, and we will replace it. You are also welcome to cook over your accommodations fire pit.



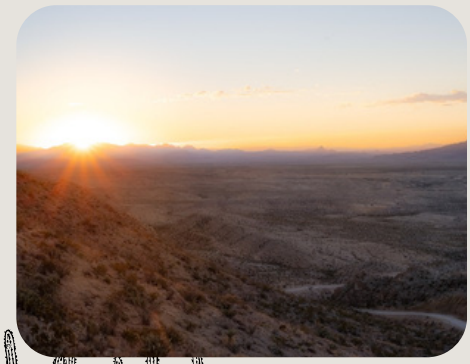


EXPLORING THE SUMMIT













Unfurling over a vast 1000 acres, The Summit is full of adventure at every turn. Journey through old mining caves, uncover remnants of history and bask in breathtaking views. Watch sunset at “The Summit” with 360 degree views of the expansive Big Bend region.

OUR HISTORY

This property was home to the Lone Star Mine, operating at different periods from the 1910s to 1950s. Mining was for Cinnabar Ore, while the waste material mainly consisted of clay and calcite. The geological formations in this area consist of limestone, which was deposited during the Upper Cretaceous epoch, approximately 66 to 100 million years ago. The Lone Star Mine lies within the Mexican Highland, a region characterized by the geomorphological feature Intermontane Plateaus, which contributes to the unique landscape. Our caves that overlook the domes are on Tres Cuevas Mountain, with an elevation of 3,635. The name means "Three Caves" in Spanish, referring to the three openings on the mountain's northwestern face.





Casa Grande, the original mining HQ

HIKE, DRIVE, AND DISCOVER



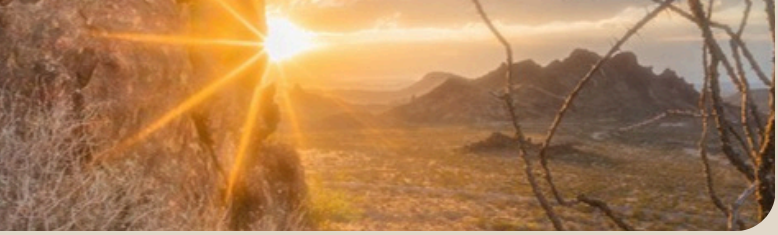




Feel the thrill of exploring our vast landscapes on foot, or take your 4x4 and ATV for a spin. We ask adventurers to be back on the front of the property shortly after sunset as the terrain plunges into darkness, and roads and trails can turn treacherous.

The old mines, caves, and cliff edges are known for their unpredictable nature. Tread with caution. Kindly familiarize yourself with our liability waiver - we are not responsible for any injuries, death, vehicle troubles, or lost/stolen items while on our property. Our priority is your safety and enjoyment, but we aren't equipped for rescue or recovery missions. The nearest major hospital is a good 4-hour drive away.
Venture responsibly.

A note on our neighbors:
As you wander and weave your way up the mountain and North-West past the “Y” in the road veering left, you’ll come across a house on your left. Respectfully acknowledge the privacy signs lining their stretch of the road. Once past their residence at the hill's crest, you'll find yourself back on Summit territory. Let's maintain a good neighborly vibe and be considerate while passing their premises. With every step, remember the mantra - **"Adventure with awareness."**

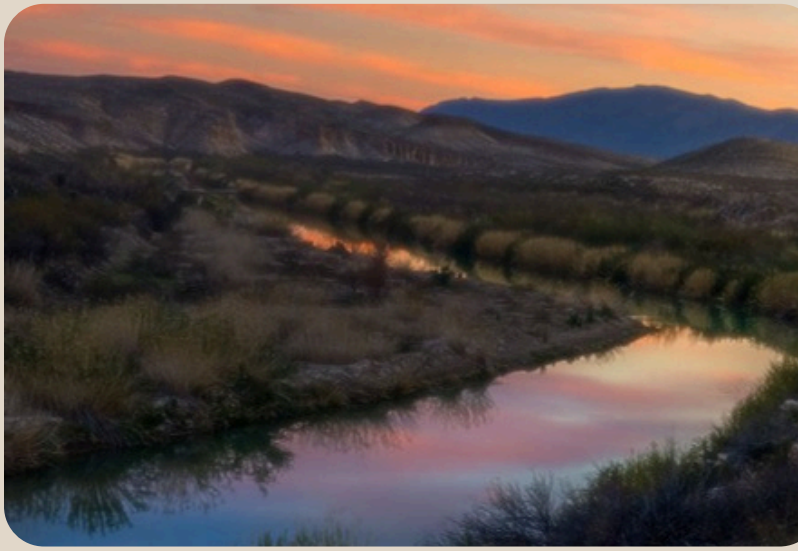




BIG BEND NATIONAL PARK







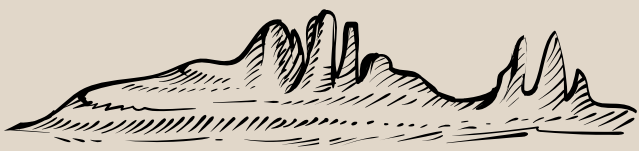




Big Bend is a treasure trove of natural wonders. Spread over 800,000 acres, this sprawling park is a haven for adventurers, nature lovers, and those seeking a tranquil escape from the hustle and bustle of daily life.

For the intrepid explorer, Big Bend offers over 150 miles of hiking trails ranging from easy walks along the Rio Grande to challenging mountain treks. Each path reveals its own secrets – from ancient fossil remains to hidden oases and breathtaking vistas.
To access Big Bend from The Summit, take highway 170 West to Study Butte, and then South 3 miles to the Maverick Junction Entrance Station.

MUST DO IN BIG BEND



- Hikes: Lost Mine Trail, Window Trail, Pine Canyon Trail, Hot Springs Trail. Window Trail
- Drive: Ross Maxwell Scenic Drive to Santa Elena Canyon
- Visit: the Hot Springs and cross over to Boquillas in Mexico (passport required!)
- Learn: Fossil Discovery Exhibit, Panther Junction Visitor Center, Chisos Basin Visitor Center



BIG BEND RANCH STATE PARK

Big Bend Ranch State Park, often referred to as "The Other Side of Nowhere," offers a vast, rugged landscape that beckons adventurers and nature enthusiasts alike. As Texas' largest state park, it extends over 300,000 acres, featuring an array of outdoor activities set against a backdrop of stunning scenic beauty

Cutting though the state park is Highway 170, also known as the River Road, is a renowned stretch of road connecting the city of Presidio to the ghost town of Terlingua. This scenic route, which extends for about sixty miles from Lajitas to Presidio, is often referred to as El Camino del Rio or "the River Road". It's celebrated for its beautiful vistas of the rugged desert landscape, the Rio Grande, and the lush areas around the river, making it one of the most picturesque drives in Texas.





MUST DO AT BIG BEND RANCH

- Hikes: Closed Canyon Trail, Big Bend Hoodoos Trail , Cinco Tinajas Loop, Lajitas Mesa Trail
- Drive: Highway 170 West past The Summit. Lajitas is the last fuel stop until Presidio
- Learn: Barton Warnock Visitors Center

TERLINGUA

A unique and captivating destination, Terlingua is brimming with enthralling experiences for visitors. Nestled in southwestern Brewster County, near the Rio Grande, this former mining district turned ghost town boasts a rich history and a plethora of activities for tourists.

History

Terlingua's history is intricately tied to mining. In the mid-1880s, the discovery of cinnabar, used to extract mercury, led to a mining boom. Despite the vagueness surrounding the exact discovery of cinnabar, it is known that Native Americans initially used it for pictographs. The mining industry flourished in the early 1900s, with several companies extracting significant quantities of mercury. This boom led to the establishment of a post office and a surge in the area's population. The name "Terlingua" may derive from "Tres Lenguas," hinting at an early mine or local feature.

Attractions and Activities

Today, the area serves primarily as a tourist destination, especially for visitors to the nearby Big Bend National Park. It offers a range of outdoor activities like rafting, canoeing, mountain biking, camping, hiking, and motorcycling. The region is also famous for its annual chili cookoffs, attracting thousands of enthusiasts each November. The Terlingua Cemetery, with graves dating back to the mining era, is another point of interest, particularly during the Dia de los Muertos celebrations. Additionally, Terlingua has featured in movies and TV shows, adding to its cultural allure



THINGS TO DO

Tour Guides, Activities and attractions in the area

EXPLORING

Big Bend Boating and Hiking Company

Hiking, camping and river tours!

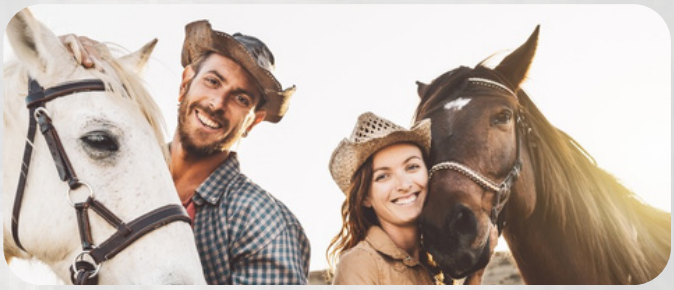
Offering a variety of hiking opportunities from short interpretive walks to rugged multi-day backpacking excursions. Experience the border from a boat, float between Texas and Mexico on the Rio Grande!



Lajitas Stables and Golf Course

Contact Lajitas Stables for a trip through the backcountry. They have hourly rides, half-day rides with lunch, or a full-day adventure.

At Lajitas Golf Resort, you will find a spa, golf course, jewelry boutique, and a big zip line. They also have an upscale bar and a restaurant.



Desert Sports Mountain Biking

Specializing in in mountain biking and river running in both Big Bend National Park and Big Bend Ranch State Park



SHOPPING & GALLERIES



Burr Rabbit's Curio Shop

Minerals, crystals, fossils, and snacks located in the Chisos Mining Company office.

Quilts by Marguerite

Making beautiful, intricate, bespoke, heirloom quilts to your exact wishes.

Galeria Chisos

Gallery featuring art, jewelry, & gifts by local artists, also a great selection of crystals, rocks and minerals.

Many Stones

Find gems, rocks, fossils, jewelry, cactus and more.

Earth and Fire Gallery

Beautiful store with eclectic art, predominately by local artists and influenced by the desert.

Terlingua Trading Company

Art, books, jewelry, and gifts. Located next to the famous Starlight Theater porch.

GROCERIES AND GAS

Cottonwood General Store

Located 14 miles from our property, this is your best option for groceries, but don't expect a supermarket!

Lajitas General Store

Located just 4 miles away, the General Store has **fantastic to-go food**, gas, supplies, firewood and more!

Alon gas station

This is the closest gas station located next to the Big Bend Motor Inn.

WHAT ARE MY FOOD OPTIONS?

Our most common question! Let's explore many of your options in the area

Long Draw Pizza

Long Draw Pizza is a must-visit destination for all our guests. Renowned for its delicious, handcrafted pizzas baked to perfection, this charming eatery offers a wide range of mouth-watering toppings to satisfy every palate. Enjoy sunset on their elevated patio and live music!



DB's Rustic Iron BBQ

At DB's, you'll discover some of the finest and most succulent brisket, ribs, turkey breast, pulled pork, and sausage in the region. Each dish is expertly smoked and seasoned, showcasing the authentic flavors and tender textures that make Texas barbecue famous



Venga Cafe

A delightful menu of breakfast items, coffee, smoothies, fajitas, sandwiches, and salads, Venga caters to all tastes. Not just a cafe, it also features a selection of outdoor gear, camping supplies, local t-shirts, and art, making it a unique one-stop shop for visitors.



Taqueria el Milagro

Located in the heart of the Terlingua Ghostown, this gem offers fresh, made-to-order Mexican cuisine that truly captures the essence of traditional recipes. Tacos, burritos, and other Mexican classics!



Places

places to eat

El Gordo's Grill
A must-visit food truck for anyone craving fantastic street tacos and authentic Mexican cuisine. Located near the Alon gas station, it is renowned for its delicious, flavorful offerings. From mouth-watering tacos to other Mexican specialties, every dish is prepared with care.



Espresso y Poco Mas
The go-to spot for exquisite coffee, fresh squeezed orange juice, and refreshing smoothies, an array of Mexican and classic breakfast and lunch dishes. A perfect spot for a relaxing meal or a quick energizing break.



La Kiva
An iconic spot in an extraordinary setting, carved from massive sandstone boulders, creating a cave-like ambiance. It embodies the essence of Terlingua - a place rich in history with walls adorned with fossils and historical local memorabilia.



High Sierra Bar & Grill
Tex-Mex favorites, grilled specialties, and classic bar food. Enjoy live music and a wide selection of drinks. The highlight is the upstairs patio, which provides an unparalleled view for watching the stunning sunset over the Chisos.



FOOD OPTIONS CONTINUED

Starlight Theater
A historic venue offering Texan and Southwestern cuisine, live music, and a rustic bar. A the perfect place to soak in the local ambiance and enjoy a delicious meal



Chili Pepper Cafe
Delight in the bold flavors of Mexican cuisine. From their signature Chile Rellenos to a variety of tacos and burritos, there's something for everyone!



Tivo's Place
Recently movedto town in a newly renovated building, Tivo's has long been regarded as one of the best Mexican food options in the area



LOCATED IN LAJITAS









Candelilla Cafe*
Offering a diverse menu of prime steaks, seafood, and signature dishes like blackened salmon and filet mignon. Enjoy the panoramic mountain views and exceptional service in a relaxed setting, perfect for any meal of the day.

Boardwalk Bakery & Pizza
Quick and delicious options, from morning coffee with Texas-sized muffins to hand-tossed pizzas at night. Enjoy their fresh salads, house-roasted sandwiches, and gourmet hot dogs throughout the day, along with beer and wine selections

The Thirsty Goat Saloon*
Named after Lajitas' goat mayor, Clay Henry, and his love for Lone Star Beer. This saloon blends Old West charm with comfortable leather sofas and chairs, creating the ideal atmosphere to unwind with friends and family.

Lajitas General Store
Do not let the General Store and Gas Station fool you – located only a few miles down the road make it one of our go-to spots. Salads with unbelievably fresh ingredients, craft burgers and much more make this an easy choice for breakfast or lunch

*Call ahead for availability if not staying with the Lajitas Resort

FAQ

Frequently Asked Questions

What time is check in/check out?
Check in is 3pm. Check out is 10am. Every property here is self check-in. We ask that you be mindful of the times so our housekeeping team can have the appropriate amount of time to sanitize every space..

Are fires allowed?
Yes, fires are allowed (even when the county is under a burn ban). Each property has its own fire pit. Firewood can be purchased at the Lajitas general store, Cottonwood general store, and the Study-Butte gas station if we do not have some on hand for you!

Are pets allowed?
We totally get it – they are part of the family! While we're big-time animal lovers as well, the National Park has a strict no-pet policy. We've noticed that this often means they have to be left behind while owners are out enjoying the park. So they end up having a less-than-fun day cooped up alone, which can lead to damages and big messes to clean up on our end.

Is there Wi-Fi?
Wi-Fi is available on-site to help you stay connected through calls, texts, and messaging. Signal strength and speeds vary, and you may need to step outside your accommodation for a better connection. We are in a very remote part of the world and outages are a real thing, however, we do our best to keep you connected!

Do I need a 4 wheel drive vehicle?
No. 4-wheel drive or AWD is always recommended out here but 2-wheel drive is just fine. Sports cars are not recommended.

What is there to do in the area?
Our properties sit on over 1,000 acres of private, raw desert land. We invite you to explore our grounds as much as you'd like! Take a hike (or a drive) up to the Summit for epic, 360-degree views of both the National and State Parks!

FAQ

How far is the BBNP park?
The entrance to the park is 17 miles from our property.

What is the closest large airport I can fly into?
Midland/Odessa airport is the closest airport for people to fly into. It is about a 3 1⁄2-4 hour drive from there to our property.

What kind of planes fly into the Lajitas airport?
All kinds of planes fly into Lajitas. Anyone can fly their own plane into the Lajitas airport with 24 hour notice to the airport FBO. (Pilots will know how to get in contact). JSX is a company that offers charters from Houston Hobby, Austin, and Dallas. They run seasonally.

Some important things to note:
This is the middle of the Chihuahuan Desert which means you might experience power outages (this includes WiFi) along with everyone else in the area. Although inconvenient, they typically do not last for more than a few hours.

DISCLAIMER

We have tried to disturb the natural landscape as little as possible. Most of our accommodations have parking next to the unit. However, the natural landscape required a few units to be built with walks of 20 yards or more and some inclines. This may include the use of stairs to reach your accommodations, the bathhouses in the Valley, or parked vehicles. If you have mobility issues, please contact us so that we may suit your needs.

Frequently Asked Questions


Enjoy Your Adventure!